Spanish rail infrastructure chief steps down after deadly crash

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By Nacho Alarcón, Martina Sapio · Nov 4, 2026, 8:42 PM · View in your browser

☐Adif President Luis Pedro Marco de la Peña has submitted his resignation to Spain’s new transport minister, Carlos Cuerpo, a Spanish government official told POLITICO.

Adif, responsible for Spain’s rail infrastructure, signaling and traffic control, is under intense scrutiny after last week’s devastating crash near Urda, Toledo, that claimed 69 lives.

This marks Cuerpo’s first decisive action since stepping into the ministry after former Transport Minister Oscar Puente’s resignation Tuesday night. Puente left his post following a marathon hearing before Congress’ Permanent Deputation, where both allies and opponents urged him to resign.

The Urda crash was Spain’s second deadly rail accident of the year, following January’s crash near Adamuz, which killed 46 people.

Earlier Wednesday, Cuerpo convened with Marco de la Peña, Renfe President Álvaro Fernández Heredia and Secretary of State for Transport José Antonio Santano.

Just a day earlier, a senior government official said there were no plans to remove Marco de la Peña and dismissed rumors of Puente’s resignation. Yet Puente stepped down only hours later.

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